

Chapter 28-2

The autumn nights in Haizou City carried a hint of coolness. Long hair hanging down could only block the neck from the wind's invasion.

But her arms were still cold.

An Omega's body was naturally more delicate than an Alpha's, and her skin felt several degrees colder.

The moment Xu Qingzhu's arm pressed against hers, Liang Shi noticed she shivered slightly, but her face showed no sign of it, still maintaining a smile that was even better than a female celebrity's expression management on the red carpet.

Liang Shi's heart tightened when she called her that, and she coughed awkwardly.

"Baby." Xu Qingzhu turned to face her, whispering coquettishly in her ear: "You're letting people call you baby again. Don't come back to the room tonight—go sleep on the sofa."

She deliberately lowered her voice, but controlled the volume just enough for Zhou Yi'an to hear.

Zhou Yi'an's expression immediately changed. "I f—"

Before she could finish her curse, Xu Qingzhu coldly interrupted her, showing none of her previous gentle demeanor. "This lady, your behavior is detrimental to our family harmony. Please conduct yourself with dignity."

Zhou Yi'an: ".....?"

"Baby." Zhou Yi'an was angered into laughter, looking at Liang Shi. "Baby, you really aren't afraid of death, are you?"

Liang Shi glanced at her, her tone indifferent. "My wife is right. Please conduct yourself with dignity."

She deliberately emphasized the words "conduct yourself with dignity."

Zhou Yi'an felt anger burning in her chest.

Xu Qingzhu then stood on her tiptoes, moving close to Liang Shi's ear, but ears were the most sensitive part of Liang Shi's body.

She couldn't stand someone suddenly getting so close, so she instinctively moved away, but Xu Qingzhu reached out and pulled her head back. Caught off guard, Xu Qingzhu's lips touched her ear.

It was even that Xu Qingzhu had planned to whisper in her ear, and just as she opened her mouth, Liang Shi's ear came closer.

She instinctively pursed her lips, just happening to capture Liang Shi's ear.

Ears were always the most susceptible to cold.

Under the autumn evening breeze, Liang Shi's ear was ice cold.

Hot lips gently pressed against the cold ear, transmitting warmth to it.

Both Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi froze for a moment.

Xu Qingzhu's heart pounded nervously. Despite the bustling banquet with many people raising glasses and chatting—it wasn't quiet at all.

But she could accurately capture the sound of a rapidly beating heart amidst all the noise and commotion.

She didn't know if it was hers or Liang Shi's.

Nervously, she instinctively licked her lips, but after extending her tongue tip and touching Liang Shi's skin, she quickly withdrew it.

Liang Shi felt moisture on her ear.

It was a soft, even hotter tongue tip than her lips, but it had just peeked out and then fearfully retreated.

Like a mimosa¹.

Liang Shi's entire body tensed up nervously, and Xu Qingzhu's hand holding her arm tightened in that instant, gently pinching the skin on the inside of her arm.

Her fingertips carried a trace of coolness.

Liang Shi let out a soft breath, and Xu Qingzhu immediately retreated.

The moment became somewhat awkward.

Xu Qingzhu had originally intended to put on a show for Zhou Yi'an, but ended up being too clever for her own good, trapping herself in an embarrassing situation.

Zhou Yi'an looked at the two of them, feeling inexplicable anger rise in her heart, and sneered: "What are you doing? In broad daylight and in front of everyone."

Zhou Yi'an's gaze swept over Liang Shi's ear. "Baby, you just said I was like a dog in heat, so what about your little Omega wife? In front of so many people, you're already about to start doting on her? Is there something you can't do at home? Or do you just like having people watch you two—do it together?"

She deliberately emphasized the word "do" heavily, adding an indescribable innuendo.

"If you really think that way, why not just take off your evening gowns? I can help you two..." Zhou Yi'an's words became increasingly vulgar. "Live stream it."

Hearing this, Liang Shi frowned and pulled Xu Qingzhu closer to her, even putting her arm around Xu Qingzhu's waist.

But it was a gentleman's hold.

She just lightly rested it on her waist, with her entire forearm suspended in air. It was quite a test of arm strength, but Liang Shi had often done this before and was already used to it, not feeling tired at all.

Xu Qingzhu's evening gown had a fitted waist, just right for her to embrace.

"Sorry." Liang Shi said: "We are a legally married couple with a marriage certificate. My wife just wanted to whisper something to me, unlike you who goes into heat anytime, anywhere toward a married Alpha. I suppose in the eyes of lewd people, everything appears lewd."

Zhou Yi'an: "....."

She directly crushed the wine glass in her hand.

Crimson wine mixed with transparent glass fell to the ground, the liquid snaking across the gray floor like blood.

This commotion caused everyone present to look over.

Liang Shi held Xu Qingzhu and stepped back, conveying only one message—she's the one going crazy, it has nothing to do with us.

Liang Xinhe approached at just the right time. He had drunk quite a bit for socializing, and since alcohol made his face flush, his complexion was now reddish. "Liang Shi, what are you doing?"

"Nothing." Liang Shi replied: "Zhu Zi² and I were just chatting."

"You chat away." Liang Xinhe said: "Sister-in-law is coming with me."

Liang Shi was puzzled: "Huh?"

"I'm taking sister-in-law to meet some people." Liang Xinhe said: "They're all in jewelry-related businesses."

Liang Shi understood—this was about expanding Xu Qingzhu's network. Naturally, she had no intention of objecting.

Only then did Liang Xinhe notice the broken wine glass on the ground and Zhou Yi'an standing there with cold, angry eyes. He immediately inquired in his capacity as host: "Miss Zhou, did something happen to you? If there's anything we can help with, please don't hesitate to ask."

Zhou Yi'an gave him a sidelong glance, her arrogant attitude fully displayed.

She didn't even bother with surface politeness.

Liang Xinhe hit a soft nail³, but was only embarrassed for a few seconds before calling to the waiters: "Quickly clean up the things on the ground, be careful not to hurt the guests."

The waiters repeatedly acknowledged.

When Liang Xinhe was about to leave with Xu Qingzhu, Liang Shi naturally wanted to follow.

But Liang Xinhe looked back at her with disgust: "What are you following for?"

Liang Shi: ".....?"

"Second brother, you're taking my wife away." Liang Shi said: "Of course I have to follow."

She didn't want to stay here alone with Zhou Yi'an.

Liang Xinhe waved his hand: "Go, go, go. I'm just taking your wife to meet a few people, I'll return her to you in a bit. You following along would just be a burden."

Liang Shi: "....."

She said weakly: "At least I'm also a member of the Liang family. I should support my wife's reputation."

Liang Xinhe suddenly paused and called her name seriously: "Liang Shi."

Liang Shi: "Yes?"

Liang Xinhe said very objectively, trying not to bring any emotion into it: "Have you really forgotten what kind of mess you used to be?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She coughed lightly: "Second brother, I've changed."

Liang Xinhe waved his hand: "Alright, I'll return your wife to you in a moment. Among the people we're meeting, there are some you've offended before. If they see you, they'll probably turn around and leave. I advise you to stay put."

After saying this, he glanced at Zhou Yi'an who was standing there like a statue, and lowered his voice: "Mom said you and Zhou Yi'an were high school classmates with a pretty good relationship. You can have a good chat with her. Our family's south city land still depends on the Zhou family."

Liang Shi: ".....?"

She couldn't tell for a moment whether what Liang Xinhe said was true or false.

But Liang Xinhe's eyes were too pure.

He looked like he was simply believing what Qiu Zimin had told him, so he didn't know that his Alpha sister was being harassed by another person of hidden gender who was 99% likely to be an Alpha.

After Liang Xinhe finished speaking, he was about to leave with Xu Qingzhu, but Xu Qingzhu lifted her skirt and said softly: "Second brother, wait a moment."

"What's the matter?" Liang Xinhe asked.

Xu Qingzhu turned around and beckoned to Liang Shi.

Liang Shi walked over unhappily: "What's wrong?"

Xu Qingzhu said: "Lower your head."

Liang Shi instinctively covered her own ears. That kind of stimulation just now was very nice, but she really couldn't handle it again.

She... really wasn't that much of a gentleman either.

Xu Qingzhu frowned slightly and whispered coquettishly: "Come here."

In others' eyes, it looked like a young couple flirting playfully.

Liang Shi also obediently bent down and lowered her head, while Xu Qingzhu raised her hand, her fingers gently brushing over Liang Shi's earlobe.

Where her fingertips passed brought a tingling, tickling sensation that extended from the tailbone all the way to the top of her head, making her nervous yet comfortable, involuntarily letting out a satisfied sigh.

This time Xu Qingzhu really lowered her voice, speaking in a volume only the two of them could hear: "Be careful of Zhou Yi'an."

Liang Shi nodded: "I know."

Footnotes:

¹ Mimosa - Also known as the "sensitive plant," this plant folds its leaves when touched, used here as a metaphor for someone who is shy and quickly retreats when approached.

² Zhu Zi - A cute nickname for Xu Qingzhu, literally meaning "little bamboo."

³ Hit a soft nail - A Chinese idiom meaning to be politely but firmly rejected or rebuffed.

Author's Note: [If any author's notes were present in the original text, they would be translated here]